

The 5 Metrics Every Web3 Community Founder Ignores

— until holders start leaving.

Most Web3 founders watch floor price and Discord member count. Neither tells you a community is dying until it already is.

METRIC	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEASURES	DANGER THRESHOLD	WHEN IT BREACHES: DO THIS
01 Day-30 Return Rate	The % of wallets that made at least one on-platform action in the first 30 days, then returned in days 31-60. Day-1 and Day-7 retention are vanity metrics. The real cliff is at Day 30, when launch energy runs out and only system-backed communities survive.	< 25%	You have no retention system — only launch energy. Add one daily reason to return: energy recharge, passive earn, or a live leaderboard with stakes.
02 Spend-to-Earn Ratio	Of all tokens earned in the last 30 days, what % were spent back into the ecosystem vs sitting idle in wallets. A healthy economy circulates. Tokens that only accumulate are a delayed dump — holders are building a sell position, not a stake.	< 30% spent back	Your sinks are too weak or too dull. Introduce a spend destination with real desire: a competitive season entry fee, a time-limited auction, or a burn-to-upgrade mechanic.
03 Free-to-Premium Conversion	Of Discord-authenticated free players who entered your platform, what % ever linked a wallet and verified NFT ownership. Free users look like activity in your dashboard. Most are not converting to the tier that sustains your economy.	< 8%	The free-to-premium gate has no pull. Give free players a specific, visible thing they cannot do without a wallet — not just "access more features", but a named, desirable outcome they can see from the free tier.
04 Energy Depletion Rate	In any action-gated system (energy, stamina, AP): what % of active players reach zero energy each day. This is your engagement calibration signal. Too low = the game is too slow and players disengage before feeling the loop. Too high = power users burn out.	< 40% or > 85%	Below 40%: reduce energy costs or add more worthwhile actions. Above 85%: add a daily bonus, premium energy pack, or slow the regen curve. The sweet spot keeps players hungry, not starved.
05 NFT Velocity Spike Index	Week-over-week change in how often NFTs in your collection change hands on secondary markets. Steady low velocity = committed holders, healthy. A sudden spike — before any announced event — is a coordinated exit signal. The floor drop follows 5-10 days later.	>2x weekly average (unprompted)	Cross-reference the wallets selling with your platform activity data. If high-PP / high-tenure holders are listing, investigate immediately. If it is low-engagement wallets, it is normal churn. The difference matters.

These systems don't track themselves.

Retention is an engineering problem. The metrics above require instrumentation — a backend that logs actions, timestamps sessions, tracks economy flow, and surfaces anomalies. That's what I build.